EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 13 OCTOBER 2026

Atari, Bulambuli District, Uganda

On the Atari floodplain, people die from the river and from the water they drink afterward. The single most important step is to get rehydration salts, zinc, and chlorine to within an hour's walk of every household, and to Bunambutye, before the end of October.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Not retrievable at this resolution. The containing district is Bulambuli, with 235,391 people (2024 census)	None published for Uganda or East Africa	n/a here. The global 6-month figure is 239,000 ± 11,000 (heat only)	Riverine and flash floods (October to December), followed by cholera and malaria. Landslides affect the upslope parishes

19/19 recommendations checked. 2 confirmed, 11 corrected, 3 unverified, and 3 contraindicated (preventive cholera vaccination, bulk net purchase, and treating the GiveDirectly Elgon programme as flood cover). **The funding target fell 45% in verification**, from about $91,000 to about $50,300. Most of the cut came from shrinking the anticipatory cash placement to a 300-household pilot. The Uganda Red Cross's only documented cash transfer in Bulambuli reached 46% of its target. Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It covers heat only and publishes no Ugandan figure, so this report gives no excess-death number, scaled or

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



1.32°N 34.36°E, Uganda · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Riverine and flash floods from October to December, then cholera: the November 1997 El Niño floods killed 35, and the cholera that followed killed 342 across the Eastern Region.
- **First action.** By 31 October 2026, the Bulambuli District Health Officer, with National Medical Stores, tops up health-centre kits and sets rehydration points at Bunambutye and every floodplain village.
- **The money.** $20,000 floor, $50,270 target, $91,630 ceiling; the Uganda Red Cross warning relay and boda evacuation, $8,000, ranks first per dollar.
- **Do not.** Do not wait for a GloFAS trigger: the Atari and Sipi are small, steep rivers that flood overnight, so a five-day GloFAS signal may never fire.

What to do	**12** actions	p. 2
Who does what	RACI chart	p. 10
Where money does the most	funding	p. 10
Do not do this	**5** items	p. 12
What has happened here	the record	p. 14
How this was produced	methodology	p. 16
References	sources	p. 18

otherwise. Heat is not the story here. **Scope.** The request said "Atari, Uganda". No sub-county or town council is named Atari. This briefing covers the lowland River Atari floodplain in Bumufuni sub-county, Bulambuli District, where Atari village and the JICA Atari irrigation scheme sit, together with the Bunambutye resettlement area beside it. If the Atari corridor downstream in Bukedea (Kamutur sub-county) was meant, the flood actions transfer, but the camp and landslide items do not.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO — RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet. **Timing:** the outlook from Uganda's national meteorological service puts the heaviest rain in late October and November, with rain lasting into early January. The local record (November 1997, October and November 2019, 1 November 2025) agrees. JICA's survey for the irrigation scheme gives the Atari flood season as August to October, so the river is already in season.

1. By 31 October, top up the kits at the health centres and village health teams, and put rehydration points at Bunambutye and in every floodplain village*

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC · PHILANTHROPIST · FRONTLINE

ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Bulambuli District Health Officer, with National Medical Stores	31 October 2026	Emergency top-up on the district's own line. The $12,000 water and sanitation placement below covers the gap	Cholera and diarrhoea deaths, and malaria deaths in children after floods

The kit: oral rehydration salts and zinc, chlorine tablets, cholera and malaria rapid tests, and artemisinin combination therapy. Chlorine goes to households that drink river or swamp water. The evidence is local. In Bulambuli's March 2016 outbreak (Bwikhonge sub-county), drinking untreated Cheptui River water carried a matched odds ratio of 7.8 (95% CI 2.7–22). The case-fatality rate was 1.9%, about twice

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

the WHO benchmark, and both deaths were people over 60. Oral rehydration salts may prevent up to 93% of diarrhoea deaths (Munos et al. 2010), though that figure rests on low-quality evidence. After the 2013 Kasese flood, malaria test positivity rose by an adjusted rate ratio of 1.30 in villages beside the river (Boyce et al. 2016).

The case-fatality and water findings come from this district. The rehydration effect size is global. **Corrections:** issue rectal artesunate only with a pre-arranged referral vehicle, because WHO's 2023 guidance after the CARAMAL study (which included Uganda) ties it to completed referral. Do not shock-chlorinate every borehole: in 2016, borehole water was *protective* (OR 0.31), so chlorinate only boreholes that were flooded or test contaminated. One more correction: no online record confirms the Atari HC II health centre, or the reported 9 km trek its staff make through floodwater. The verified facilities are Bunambutye Resettlement HC III and Muyembe HC IV.

2. Treat the Bunambutye camp as the district's highest-risk site, and agree night shelters in solid buildings for storm and flood nights

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Bulambuli District Disaster Management Committee, with the Office of the Prime Minister (camp management) and the Uganda Red Cross	**31 October 2026**	**Mostly staff time. The UGX 15–25M estimate for drainage and re-staking is the lens's and is unverified**	**Another night with families under collapsed tents, and cholera in a camp on the floodplain**

The landslide survivors were moved downhill into the flood zone. At its peak on 11 December 2024, the camp held about 2,200 households (13,200 people). At about 7pm on 20 December 2024, a windstorm destroyed four Red Cross tents, and the women's tent had to be moved into school staff quarters. That move is the precedent for using schools as storm shelters (IFRC DREF MDRUG053 final report). By April 2026, 461 of the 1,224 households placed there had stayed. Only 121 had received the promised UGX 10 million and 2 acres at Girik, Kween. Any costing has to start with the October 2026 headcount, which nobody has published.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Feasible before the peak, and cheap. One correction to a lens claim: clean water was not delayed nine months. From the start, 40,000 litres a day were trucked in and 3 boreholes were drilled.

3. Build the warning on people the community already trusts, not on SMS or sirens: upstream river watchers, church and mosque relays, named gathering points, and a list of who needs carrying

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC · EMERGENCY MANAGER · PHILANTHROPIST · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Uganda Red Cross, Bulambuli sub-branch, with village (LC1) chairs and village health teams	Register and gathering points agreed by 31 October	$8,000 (megaphones, boda transport, and a staff gauge read by a volunteer)	Older people, people with disabilities, and pregnant women being left behind in a night flash flood

The plan has five parts:

- Walk every homestead near the Atari banks.
- List older people, people with disabilities, pregnant women, and child-headed homes.
- Give each of them a named neighbour and a boda rider.
- Agree two or three raised gathering points per village with the LC1 chair.
- Pass upstream heavy-rain reports down through church bells, mosque loudspeakers, boda stages, and Lumasaba-language call-in shows on Open Gate FM.

The evidence is local and negative. Butaleja, downstream on the same plain, installed flood-warning units in 2014–15. Both had failed by about 2016, from vandalism, theft of the solar panels, and no maintenance (ITU; Uganda Radio Network). In Bududa, the channels that actually reached people were radio (44%) and clan networks (20%). That comes from a preprint with 82 respondents, and only 40% of women were reached by radio.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The Bududa evidence is from a neighbouring Elgon district, so it transfers well, but it is thin. The Uganda Red Cross sub-branch was among the first responders on 1 November 2025, so it is a real delivery channel.

4. Ask for the money now, on the forecast. The district asks the Office of the Prime Minister for a forecast-based release from the Contingencies Fund, and the Red Cross checks what is left in its flood protocol

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · EMERGENCY MANAGER · FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Chief Administrative Officer, Bulambuli, to the Office of the Prime Minister (NECOC). Uganda Red Cross headquarters to IFRC	**This week**	**A letter. Cabinet decides the amount**	**Relief that arrives a month late, as the iron sheets did in Mbale**

There is a precedent for releasing money before a forecast disaster. In July 2026, Cabinet approved UGX 50 billion from the Contingencies Fund *ahead of* expected El Niño dry conditions in Karamoja. The fund is legally 0.5% of the appropriated budget (PFMA s.26). A district declaration does not release it: Cabinet does, and releases are slow. On the Red Cross side, Bulambuli is one of the 14 target districts in the Uganda Red Cross flood Early Action Protocol (EAP2021UG01). But the November 2023 activation acted only in Ntoroko, Butaleja, and Kikuube. The April 2024 financial report shows CHF 86,600 left of CHF 348,761, and the documents give the end date as 27 May 2026, 31 July 2026, or 30 November 2026. No renewal was found.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Two corrections to the Economist lens. First, Bulambuli is inside the protocol; it simply was not reached in 2023. Second, a "repayment holiday" on Parish Development Model loans is not an existing entitlement. In February 2026 the Ministry of Finance ordered districts to *recover* those loans, so treat it only as a waiver request.

5. Pilot anticipatory cash for 300 floodplain households, released on a heavy-rain alert rather than on GloFAS alone

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED (SCALED DOWN) · PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC · FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Uganda Red Cross, Bulambuli sub-branch (mobile money)	Households registered by 31 October; trigger agreed in writing	$20,700 (300 × $60 × 1.15)	Households selling seed and livestock, and going without food when roads are cut

In Bangladesh's 2020 floods, a BDT 4,500 transfer (about $53) sent before the peak left recipients 36% less likely to go a day without eating (Pople et al.). That study was quasi-experimental, not a trial, and it measured welfare, not deaths. This is why cash ranks below the health and warning actions here. A surplus maize market with working traders favours cash over food.

Why it was scaled back: the Red Cross's 2024–25 landslide cash transfer in Bulambuli reached 367 of the 796 people targeted (MDRUG053). The Atari and Sipi flash floods arrive overnight, and nobody has shown that GloFAS forecasts them skilfully. The Makerere evaluation behind EGU22-3341 recommends GloFAS mainly for larger catchments. So the trigger should be a heavy-rain alert from Uganda's meteorological service combined with a volunteer reading a staff gauge.

6. List every floodplain woman due between November and January, and move her to a waiting shelter at an HC III or HC IV before the roads close *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · PUBLIC HEALTH · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
District Health Officer, with village health teams	List by 31 October; moves by mid-November	Staff time, plus a midwife deployed to Bunambutye HC III	Obstructed labour and haemorrhage while the roads are flooded

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

An HC II does not normally handle deliveries. The nearest facilities that can manage obstetric emergencies are Bunambutye Resettlement HC III (commissioned 2021) and Muyembe HC IV. The evidence for maternity waiting homes is observational. One review found maternal deaths at OR 0.20 and stillbirths at OR 0.27, but with heavy selection bias.

The evidence is thin but the action is cheap, and the flood-season road cut is documented.

7. In October, move stored grain to high ground. Keep dry hermetic bags for the late-November-to-January harvest

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED (TIMING CORRECTED) | FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
District Production Office, with farmer groups and village savings and loan associations (VSLAs)	Lifting grain now; bags by late November	Hermetic bags cost about US$2–4 each (Purdue). No current shilling price was found	Losing the household's stores, and aflatoxin in wet grain

The 1 November 2025 flood washed out 2,775 acres of maize, rice, groundnuts, and sunflower in six sub-counties. In this place the market does not run out of food; the 20 km from field to market fails. Second-season grain in eastern Uganda comes in from late November to January (FEWS NET), so tarpaulins and bags handed out in October would mostly protect grain that is already in store.

Hermetic bags stop aflatoxin only if the grain is dried below 14% moisture (Ng'ang'a 2016), which is hard to do in a wet harvest. Drying comes first.

8. Get a written gate-operation and breach plan for the half-built Atari irrigation scheme from MAAIF and JICA before the peak

CONFIRMED | SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Ministry of Agriculture (MAAIF), with JICA and Zenitaka (the contractor)	31 October 2026	Nil	New embankments sending water onto neighbouring homes in their first flood season

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The scheme covers 680 ha. Ground was broken on 27 March 2025 and it is due at the end of 2026. Its design includes embankments, flood-protection dykes, and check and diversion gates. JICA's survey says the downstream area faces both Atari river floods *and* backwater from the wetland. The operations section covers only irrigation gates. No breach or emergency plan was found, and the dykes are designed to protect the irrigated area, not the settlements.

This is the scheme's first peak season, and it is untested.

9. On heavy-rain alerts, rope off and marshal the Atari, Simu, and Sironko crossings *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED (NO EVIDENCE OF EFFECT) · EMERGENCY MANAGER · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sub-county chiefs, police, and boda-boda stage chairs	25 October 2026	About UGX 50,000 per marshal-day (lens estimate)	Riders swept off crossings

At about 6pm on 20 August 2025, six people were swept off two motorcycles at the River Kyuma crossing (Chuma village, Lusha sub-county). Four bodies were still missing when it was reported.

The incident is real, and it is the only one documented. No data show that crossings are the main cause of flood deaths here, and no evaluation anywhere shows that controlling crossings reduces drowning. It is cheap and plausible, not evidenced.

10. Upslope (Masugu, Buluganya, Namisuni): households in cracked-ground zones sleep elsewhere on heavy-rain nights *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Village (LC1) chairs, with the District Disaster Management Committee	Now, through January	Close to nil	Another evening burial

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The Masugu and Buluganya landslide struck on the evening of 27 November 2024. It killed 49 people, and about 38 were still unaccounted for in February 2025 (IFRC final report). Buluganya also slid in August 2011. This item is district-wide; it does not apply to Atari itself, which is on the lowland.

The exact time of 7pm and the crack zones could not be confirmed from a primary source. Some high-risk residents refused to register for relocation for cultural or religious reasons, so a night-time move is the realistic ask, not a permanent one.

11. Clear culverts and drains on the Atari floodplain itself

UNVERIFIED | HISTORIAN · FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Bulambuli district works	31 October 2026	District budget, or cash-for-work	Water ponding on roads and homes

The lenses cited the district engineer's November 2025 finding that a channel was silted and narrowed by boulders. That channel is at the Biritanyi Gorge road in Lusha, which is upland and not on the Atari.

It is sensible maintenance, but it needs its own local survey before anyone pays for it.

12. Ask the Parish Development Model Secretariat for a repayment waiver for flood-hit borrowers

UNVERIFIED | ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Chief Administrative Officer, Bulambuli, to the PDM Secretariat and the Ministry of Finance	After any flood declaration	Nil to the district	Borrowers selling assets to repay in a flood season

Each parish SACCO receives UGX 100 million a year in two tranches. No provision for a disaster moratorium exists, and current policy runs the other way: recovery.

This is a request, not an entitlement.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	District Health Officer	District Disaster Mgmt Committee / CAO	Uganda Red Cross (Bulambuli)	Office of the Prime Minister	LC1 chairs & VHTs	MAAIF / JICA
1. Health kits and rehydration points	**A/R**	**I**	**C**	**I**	**R**	
2. Bunambutye night shelters	**C**	**A**	**R**	**R**	**C**	
3. Community warning relay and register	**I**	**C**	**A/R**		**R**	
4. Forecast-based funding request	**C**	**A/R**	**R**	**C**		
5. Anticipatory cash pilot		**C**	**A/R**	**I**	**C**	
6. Maternity listing and waiting shelter	**A/R**	**I**			**R**	
7. Grain to high ground; dry storage		**A**			**R**	
8. Irrigation scheme gate and breach plan		**C**			**I**	**A/R**
9. River-crossing marshals		**A**	**C**		**R**	
10. Upslope night moves		**A**	**C**		**R**	
11. Floodplain drains		**A/R**			**C**	**C**
12. PDM repayment waiver request		**A/R**		**C**	**I**	

What the chart shows: the District Disaster Management Committee and the Chief Administrative Officer are accountable for the most rows (seven). The village chairs and village health teams do the most work (nine rows), and they are unpaid. Rows 4, 8, and 12 need a decision or a letter, not money.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

FLOOR
$20,000

TARGET
$50,270

CEILING
$91,630

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY
Whether the Red Cross can deliver cash here at speed, and whether any trigger catches these flash floods

The arithmetic:

- **Floor:** warning relay $8,000 + water and sanitation $12,000 = $20,000.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Target:** $8,000 + $12,000 + cash pilot $20,700 + malaria buffer $5,000 (contingent) = $45,700, plus 10% contingency = $50,270.
- **Ceiling:** $8,000 + $12,000 + cash for 700 households $48,300 + malaria $15,000 = $83,300, plus 10% = $91,630.
- **Movement:** the target fell 45% from the lens's $91,000.
- **Basis for the counts:** household numbers are anchored on the 665 households hit on 1 November 2025, not divided from any national total.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Uganda Red Cross, Bulambuli sub-branch	Action 3: river watch, megaphones, boda evacuation of people who cannot walk	$8,000	Direct grant	No published cost per death averted; a judgment amount at this size. The sub-branch was a first responder on 1 November 2025	Confirmed
District Health Officer and village health teams	Action 1: chlorine tablets, rehydration salts and zinc, and rehydration corners for about 700 floodplain households	$12,000	In-kind procurement, itemised	Household chlorination costs about $53 per DALY averted in WHO Africa-E (Clasen et al. 2007, DCP3 Annex 9C, 2005 costs, so indicative only). The lens cited a Malawi vaccine figure, which does not apply	Partially confirmed
Uganda Red Cross, Bulambuli sub-branch	Action 5: anticipatory cash for 300 households	$20,700 (to $48,300 at ceiling)	Cash transfer by mobile money, released on a trigger	Pople et al., Bangladesh 2020: 36% fewer days without food. The 2024–25 delivery record in Bulambuli reached 46% of its target	Partially confirmed; contraindicated at the proposed 700-household starting scale
District Health Officer	Action 1: malaria tests and treatment for the post-flood surge	$5,000 (to $15,000)	Released only against a written stock-out request	No usable published basis: the "$5,700 per life" figure traced only to a forum post. Bulambuli is not shown to run community case management, and National Medical Stores may already supply this	Unverified

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The funder's one thing: do not buy nets. The Global Fund and the Government of Uganda's Wave 2 campaign (April 2026) lists Bulambuli. The cheapest life saved here is a sachet of rehydration salts within walking distance of an older person with cholera. The most expensive mistake would be cash that arrives after the river has already risen.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here.

Do not run a preventive cholera vaccination campaign now

CONTRAINDICATED

Uganda has no confirmed 2026 cholera outbreak. A claimed August 2026 outbreak in Kasese was fact-checked as false. A Makerere study reports that domestic transmission has stopped, with endemic districts down from 36 to 6 by 2024 and every outbreak since 2021 imported. The global emergency stockpile stood at about 3.88 million doses at the end of August 2026, below its 5 million target. One dose protects children aged 1–4 only about 16% (Qadri et al. 2016). Requesting doses now draws on a scarce stockpile for low expected benefit.

Instead: pre-position cholera rapid tests, and agree with the Ministry of Health now how a reactive request to the international vaccine stockpile (ICG) would run if a case is confirmed.

Do not spend flood money buying bulk mosquito nets

CONTRAINDICATED

The Wave 2 campaign (April 2026, 32 districts, 4.8 million nets) names Bulambuli. Buying nets duplicates money that is already committed, while malaria *treatment* after floods is the real gap.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: ask the District Health Officer for distribution coverage in the floodplain and at Bunambutye, and fund only proven gaps, such as nets lost in a flood.

Do not wait for a GloFAS trigger before acting

CONTRAINDICATED

The Atari and Sipi are small, steep rivers coming off Mount Elgon, and the 1 November 2025 flood came overnight. Makerere's evaluation recommends GloFAS mainly for larger catchments, and the smallest one it tested was the 462 km² Manafwa. A protocol that waits for a five-day GloFAS signal may never fire here.

Instead: treat the seasonal outlook as enough to pre-position supplies now, and release cash on a local heavy-rain alert combined with a staff gauge.

Do not issue blanket "relocate from flood-prone areas" advisories, and do not rely on SMS or new sensors as the warning

CONTRAINDICATED

Most people cannot follow these advisories, so they ignore them. Only 461 of 1,224 households stayed at the resettlement camp, and some high-risk residents refused to register at all. Butaleja's sensor-based warning system was dead within about two years.

Instead: name specific gathering points per village, and run the warning through radio, clan, church, and boda relays (action 3).

Do not assume the new irrigation dykes protect the villages, and do not treat the GiveDirectly Elgon programme as flood cover

CONTRAINDICATED

The Atari scheme's dykes protect the irrigated block. Nobody has tested them in a flood season, and no breach plan was found. GiveDirectly's Elgon programme (2022–23, with the Office of the Prime Minister) paid about $1,800 to roughly 4,000 households to move out of *upland landslide zones*, mainly in Bududa, Manafwa, Sironko, and Namisindwa. It does not cover lowland floods in Bumufuni.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: get the written gate and breach plan (action 8), and fund lowland flood cash separately (action 5).

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Nov 1997 (El Niño)	Floods and landslides across eastern Uganda; Mbale, which then included Bulambuli, was worst hit	35 dead, about 20,000 displaced (Dartmouth Flood Observatory 1286). The cholera that followed killed 342 people in the Eastern Region out of 7,535 cases by 24 March 1998 (WHO)	The disease killed far more than the water. That lesson is still not built into plans
2007	Teso floods, downstream	About 300,000 affected. Officials counted 18 dead; local leaders counted 45	The death count was never reconciled
Aug 2011	Sisiyi and Buluganya landslides	40 or more dead	Bunambutye land bought in 2013; 900 houses promised and about 101 built, more than 90 of them cracked within 3 years
Mar 2016	Cholera, Bwikhonge sub-county	108 cases, 2 deaths, both over 60	Untreated Cheptui River water identified as the driver
Oct–Nov 2019 (Indian Ocean Dipole)	Bulambuli and Butaleja floods	950 or more houses flooded; 4,500 or more people needing shelter	Nothing recorded
Jul–Aug and Sep 2022	River Atari floods in Kamutur, Bukedea; the Simu washed away five bridges	More than 1,000 displaced; over 12,000 gardens and 344 latrines lost	Red Cross cash in 2023
Nov 2023 (El Niño)	Red Cross flood protocol activated across 16 districts	Bulambuli is a target district but did not receive early action	CHF 86,600 left; no renewal found

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
27 Nov 2024	Masugu and Buluganya landslide	49 dead, about 38 missing	About 13,200 people moved into tents at Bunambutye on the floodplain
Mar 2025	Rain and windstorms in seven Bumufuni villages	About 100 homes destroyed	Residents appealed to the Office of the Prime Minister
20 Aug 2025	River Kyuma crossing, Lusha	6 swept off motorcycles	Nothing recorded
1 Nov 2025	The Atari, Sipi, Simu, and Muyembe rivers overflow in six sub-counties, including Bumufuni	665 households (3,327 people); 207 houses destroyed, 438 damaged; 2,775 acres of crops lost	The president promised 2 acres and UGX 10 million per landslide family; 121 of 1,224 households had been paid by April 2026

The recurrence nobody has noticed: the state's answer to the mountain was to move people onto the river. Bunambutye sits in the same lowland as Atari, and it floods in the same weeks. Moving people off the slopes swapped landslide risk for flood and cholera risk, in the same season. And the killing window, late October to November, has repeated in 1997, 2019, 2024, and 2025, in El Niño years and in other years alike.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE

UNRESOLVED

- **A wet season** versus **a dry one**. Uganda's national meteorological service expects enhanced October–December rain over the Eastern region. ICPAC's regional September–November outlook shows drier than usual for eastern Uganda. The Skeptic's answer, which this report adopts, is to spend only on actions that also pay off in an ordinary rainy season.
- **An El Niño problem** versus **a bad-flood-year problem**. The Food Supply Chain lens notes that the floods of 2019, 2024, and 2025 all came in years without El Niño. El Niño changes the odds here, not the type of hazard.
- **Peak in late October and November** (the local record and the meteorological outlook) versus **August to October** (JICA's design survey). Both may be right for different floods: river floods earlier, flash floods later.
- **Preventive cholera vaccine and nets** (Public Health lens) versus **reactive vaccination only, and no new nets** (Philanthropist). Verification sided with the Philanthropist; see "Do not do this".

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED

BLIND SPOT

Several actions rely on schools as night shelters. No lens checked whether the national primary leaving exams (usually early November) and the secondary exams (October–November) occupy those buildings during the flood peak. No lens covered people with disabilities beyond listing them, mental health in a camp that has waited two years, or the upstream catchment in Kween, where land use controls how fast the Atari rises. That is the long-term question for a rangelands-restoration organisation, and nothing in this briefing answers it.

HOW TO READ THIS

METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED

METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request read "atari, uganda". It was resolved to the River Atari floodplain of Bumufuni sub-county, Bulambuli District, including Atari village and the Bunambutye resettlement area, because that is the only verified settlement named Atari. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as the report records it: not resolved; the containing district is Bulambuli (235,391). Mortality figures exist only at that scale (impact regions average roughly 300,000 people); sub-county detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Where heat is not the dominant hazard, the historical record carries the hazard instead of a borrowed number.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief: an emergency manager, a public health scientist, a frontline responder, a skeptic, an economist, a historian, a philanthropist, and a food supply chain analyst.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Five separate verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). The five covered health, warning and the camp, financial instruments, food and works, and the funding envelope. Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not consulted. The inventory renders client-side, and the verifiers' fetches returned an empty shell (0 entries). No action here should be read as lacking a precedent; it was not checked.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (rehydration and medicines, women due to give birth, flooded crossings, and sleeping away from landslide ground) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. Also:
  - The impact region was not resolved.
  - The Atari HC II health centre could not be confirmed online.
  - The October 2026 camp headcount is unpublished.
  - The meteorological service's website returned 401, so its bulletin was read through press and ministry pages.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- No public real-time river gauge series exists for the Atari or the Sironko.
- All local costs in shillings are lens estimates.

References (✓ verified by a verifier agent against the primary source · ~ partly verified or secondary · ? not verified) · ✓ Uganda Red Cross, Bulambuli floods, 1 Nov 2025 · ✓ IFRC DREF MDRUG053 final report (landslide, camp, cash) · ✓ Uganda floods EAP2021UG01 · ✓ EAP activation, Nov 2023 · ✓ EAP financial report, Apr 2024 · ✓ Bulambuli cholera outbreak 2016 · ✓ Munos et al. 2010, ORS · ✓ Boyce et al. 2016, Kasese flood malaria · ✓ PesaCheck, no Aug 2026 cholera outbreak · ~ Makerere cholera elimination study (press) · ✓ Gavi, OCV supply 2026 · ~ Uganda Media Centre, Wave 2 nets (search excerpt; page 404) · ✓ Bunambutye HC III · ~ Maternity waiting homes review · ✓ Monitor, Apr 2026, camp and Girik resettlement · ~ River Kyuma crossing, Aug 2025 (single source) · ✓ ITU, Butaleja early-warning units · ~ Bududa warning channels (preprint) · ~ EGU22-3341, GloFAS in Uganda · ✓ JICA Atari irrigation survey · ✓ JICA, Atari groundbreaking 2025 · ✓ Parliament, Contingencies Fund · ~ UGX 50bn pre-release for Karamoja, Jul 2026 (secondary) · ✓ PDM loan recovery order, Feb 2026 · ✓ Pople et al., Bangladesh anticipatory cash · ✓ GiveDirectly Uganda · ✓ DCP3 Annex 9C, WASH cost-effectiveness · ✓ FEWS NET Uganda, Sep 2026 · ~ Hermetic storage and aflatoxin · ✓ Monitor, Biritanyi channel, Nov 2025 · ✓ Dartmouth Flood Observatory 1286 (1997) · ✓ WHO cholera, Uganda 1998 · ~ ReliefWeb, 2007 floods · ~ Al Jazeera, Aug 2011 landslides · ~ Monitor, cracked Bunambutye houses · ~ ACAPS, 2019 floods · ✓ Uganda Red Cross, Bukedea 2022 floods · ✓ Monitor, Bumufuni Mar 2025 · ~ ICPAC seasonal forecast · ? Ministry of Water and Environment, SOND 2026 outlook

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 13 October 2026 for Atari, Bulambuli District, Uganda. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.